

Rigging
A mass of rigging controlled the ship's vast expanse of sail – around 16,000 sq m (4 acres) in total.



Block and line
Experienced sailors had complete mastery of the the ship's complex cordage.



High climb
The main mast reaches 67m (220ft) above sea level at its tip. Fatal falls were common as men climbed on the yard arms to set or furl sails.



Jeer blocks
Under the top (platform) on each mast the lower yard is held in place by four huge pieces of wood called jeer blocks.



Victory restored
HMS *Victory* has been restored to its condition before the battle of Trafalgar and now stands in dry dock at Portsmouth, on the south coast of England. It is the oldest ship in the world that is still officially commissioned in naval service.



Heavy anchors
It required the effort of 144 men, pushing on the bars of two linked capstans, to raise the largest anchors, which weighed more than 4.5 tons.



Ship's figurehead
The figurehead had two cupids supporting the royal coat of arms. Fitted in 1803, it was much simpler than the original figurehead of 1765.



Forecastle
The fore- and mainmasts were controlled from the forecastle. The ship's bell in the centre of the deck was rung every half hour. On the left are two carronades, powerful short-barrelled, short-range guns.